

What are Makhaarij?

Makhaarij (singular: makhraj) are the articulation points — the specific places in the mouth, throat, or lips where each Arabic letter is produced. Every letter must come from its correct point to be pronounced properly.

The 5 Makhaarij Areas

1. Al-Jawf (Empty Space)

- Letters: Long vowels Alif (aa), Waw (oo), Ya (ee)

Sound resonates in open mouth/throat cavity

2. Al-Halq (Throat)

- Letters: Hamza, Ha, Ayn, Ha-deep, Ghayn, Kha

3 levels: bottom, middle, top of throat

3. Al-Lisaan (Tongue)

- Letters: Most Arabic letters — 18 letters

Different positions: root, middle, tip of tongue

4. Ash-Shafataan (Lips)

- Letters: Ba, Meem, Waw, Fa

Ba/Meem: lips meet; Fa: lower lip + upper teeth

5. Al-Khayshoom (Nasal)

- Letters: Ghunnah of Noon and Meem

Nasal cavity — produces the humming sound

The 6 Throat Letters in Detail

Position	Letters	Description
Deepest (bottom throat)	Hamza (') and Ha (h-light)	Like a sigh from deep — Ha as in 'uh'
Middle throat	Ayn (') and Ha (h-deep)	Ayn = squeeze throat. Ha-deep = strong H
Closest to mouth	Ghayn (gh) and Kha (kh)	Ghayn = gargle. Kha = Scottish 'loch'

The 4 Lip Letters

- Ba (b) — Both lips meet completely and release
- Meem (m) — Both lips meet + air flows through nose (ghunnah)
- Waw (w) — Lips rounded but DON'T touch — air flows between

- Fa (f) — Lower lip touches upper front teeth — like English F

Key Reminders

- ★ In English we may pronounce Ha, Kha, and Ayn all as 'h'. In Arabic these are 3 DIFFERENT letters from 3 DIFFERENT places. Confusing them changes words.
- ★ Practice each makhraj physically — touch your throat while saying throat letters to feel them.
- ★ There are 17 makhaarij points but 28 letters — some share a makhraj but differ in characteristics (sifaat).